

英語原書講読入門

Introduction to Academic Reading in English

Syllabus Fall 2026

Course Information

Instructor	Zeyu Lyu
Meeting time	Friday 13:00–14:30
Location	[classroom]
Contact	lyu.zeyu.e8@tohoku.ac.jp
Main text	Matthew J. Salganik, <i>Bit by Bit: Social Research in the Digital Age</i> (Princeton University Press, 2018). Link 
Japanese edition	マシュー・J. サルガニック (著)、瀧川裕貴・常松淳・阪本拓人・大林真也 (訳) 『ビット・バイ・ビット——デジタル社会調査入門』有斐閣、2019年 (Link )

Course Objectives

1. Learn how to read and understand academic texts in English.
2. Learn how to find and use relevant background information to better understand academic texts in English.
3. Learn how to summarize and present academic texts in English.
4. Develop a basic understanding of computational social science and its research methods.

Assessment

- Attendance and class participation: 70%
- Group presentation: 30%

Schedule

#	Date	Topic	Format
1	Oct 2	Introduction	
2	Oct 9	Observing behavior I (Chapter 2)	
3	Oct 30	Observing behavior II (Chapter 2)	
4	Nov 6	Asking questions I (Chapter 3)	
5	Nov 13	Asking questions II (Chapter 3)	
6	Nov 20	Running experiments I (Chapter 4)	
7	Nov 27	Running experiments II (Chapter 4)	
8	Dec 4	Creating mass collaboration I (Chapter 5)	
9	Dec 11	Creating mass collaboration II (Chapter 5)	
10	Dec 18	Ethics (Chapter 6) and The future (Chapter 7)	
11	Dec 25	Presentations	Online
12	Jan 8	Presentations	Online
13	Jan 15	Presentations	Online
14	Jan 22	Presentations	
15	Jan 29	Presentations	
16	Feb 3 (Wed)	Wrap-up and reserve session	

Note: There are no classes on October 16 or 23 because of the university festival. Class dates and the course schedule are subject to change.

Course Content

5.1 Reading the English Texts

- The main text is written in English. Students are expected to read the assigned chapters in English before each class. Students are encouraged to use dictionaries and other resources to help them understand the text.
- In each class, the instructor will explain the main points of the assigned chapter and discuss any questions or difficulties that students may have. Students are encouraged to ask questions and participate in the discussion.

5.2 Presentations

- Groups will normally consist of two or three students; the final number of groups will be determined after enrollment is finalized.
- Each group will choose one paper from a reading list provided by the instructor.
- Each group will have 30–45 minutes for its presentation and the discussion that follows. Two groups will present in each session.
- The presentation order will be announced on December 4. Please form your group by that date.